Merits:

- Useful for pilot study.
- Use the results that are easily available.
- Processes of picking people in the most convenient and faster way to immediately get their reactions to a certain hot and controversial topic.
- Minimum time needed and minimum cost incurs.

Limitations:

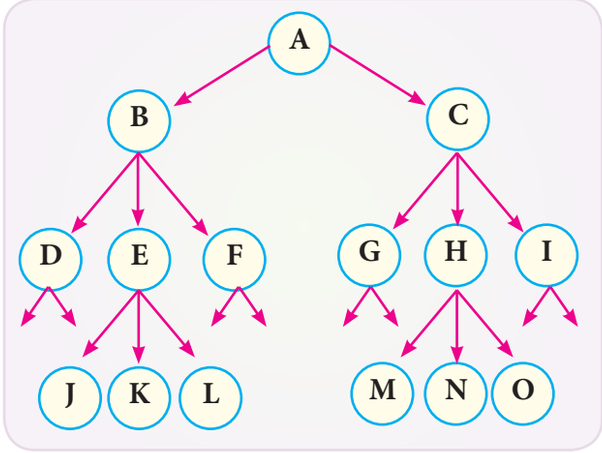
- High risk of selection bias.
- May provide misleading information.
- Not representative sample. Errors occur in the form of the members of the population who are infrequent or non users of that location and who are not related with the study.

NOTE

The use of convenience sampling technique is discouraged by many researchers due to inability to generalize research findings, the relevance of bias and high sampling error. Nevertheless convenience sampling may be the only option available in certain situations. For example, "it may be that a researcher intends to study the 'customer satisfaction of Jet Airways' he use the convenient sampling because he has been able to negotiate access through available contacts".

2.8.2 Snowball Sampling:

In this type, initial group of respondents are selected. Those respondents are requested to provide the names of additional respondents who belong to the target population of interest. It is a sampling method that involves the assistance of study subjects to identify other potential subjects in studies where subjects are hard to locate such as sex workers, drug abusers, etc. This type of sampling technique works like a chain referral. Therefore it is also called chain referral sampling.



Merits:

- Appropriate for small specialized population.
- Useful in studies involving respondents rare to find.

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